

Maria Korochkina, PhD

✉ m.korochkina@aston.ac.uk
ORCID: 0000-0002-8017-7855

🌐 Personal website
OSF

🌐 LinkedIn
Google Scholar

💬 BlueSky
ResearchGate

My research focuses on how we acquire **linguistic knowledge** and how language experience supports learning **across domains** and **throughout life**. I draw on methods from **cognitive science**, **neuroscience**, and **computational approaches to language**, and have strong expertise in **applied statistics**. I am passionate about promoting **transparency** and **reproducibility** in research as well as **making science accessible** to the wider community.

Academic appointments

- 01/2026 – present 📌 **Vice-Chancellor's Research Prize Fellow** (tenure-track), Aston University, UK
- 06/2022 – 12/2025 📌 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, Royal Holloway, Univ. of London, UK
- 02/2020 – 06/2022 📌 **Academic Tutor**, Macquarie University, Australia
- 07/2016 – 08/2018 📌 **Research Assistant**, [NOLA Lab](#) & [Vasishth Lab](#), University of Potsdam, Germany

Education

- 2022 📌 **PhD in Cognitive Science**
Joint degree from Macquarie University (Australia) and Universities of Potsdam (Germany), Newcastle upon Tyne (UK), Groningen (Netherlands), Trento (Italy), [IDEALAB PhD programme](#)
- 2018 📌 **MSc in Experimental and Clinical Linguistics**
University of Potsdam, Germany, [IECL programme](#)
- 2015 📌 **MA in Philology**
Lomonosov Moscow State University, Russia
2012 & 2014, Student exchange, University of Vienna, Austria

Teaching

- 06/2025 – 03/2026 📌 **Data analysis training developer**, South East Doctoral Training Arc (SEDARC)
- 27/03/2023 📌 **Instructor**, Bayesian LME and Distributional Regression models with *brms*, Royal Holloway, Univ. of London
- 02/2020 – 06/2022 📌 **Academic Tutor**, Macquarie University
Session 1, 2021 & 2022: [Design and Statistics III](#)
Session 2, 2020 & 2021: [Design and Statistics II](#)
Session 2, 2020 & 2021: [Acquired Speech and Language Disorders](#)
Session 1, 2020: [Exp Design and Data Analysis for the Cognitive and Brain Sciences](#)
- 18/02/2021 📌 **Instructor**, Data analysis using (generalised) linear mixed effects models in R, Macquarie University
- 21–25/09/2020 📌 **Instructor**, [Introduction to R](#), Software Carpentry

Publications

Pre-registrations, materials, data, and analysis code for all papers are available at <https://osf.io/zf8px/>.

- 📌 Cooper, H., **Korochkina, M.**, Brysbaert, M., & Rastle, K. (2026). Assessing text experience in British primary school children: New validated title and author recognition tests. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, E-pub ahead of print. <https://doi.org/10.1177/17470218261421104>.

- **Korochkina, M.**, Marelli, M., & Rastle, K. (2026). Morphemes in the wild: Modelling affix learning from the noisy landscape of natural text. *Journal of Memory and Language*, 148, 104746. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jml.2026.104746>.
- **Korochkina, M.**, Cooper, H., Brysbaert, M., & Rastle, K. (2026). Morpheme knowledge is shaped by information available through orthography. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 33, 3. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-025-02830-2>.
- **Korochkina, M.**, & Rastle, K. (2025). Morphology in children's books, and what it means for learning. *npj Science of Learning*, 10:22. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41539-025-00313-6>.
- **Korochkina, M.**, & Rastle, K. (2025). The vocabulary barrier in the General Certificate of Secondary Education (GCSE) in English Literature. *The Use of English*, 76(2), 12–26. <https://englishassociation.ac.uk/the-use-of-english/>. Also available at <https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/vg8c3>
- Crawford, M., Raheel, N., **Korochkina, M.**, & Rastle, K. (2024). Inadequate foundational decoding skills constrain global literacy goals for pupils in low- and middle-income countries. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 9, 74–83. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02028-x>
- **Korochkina, M.**, Nickels, L., & Bürki, A. (2024). What can we learn about integration of novel words into semantic memory from automatic semantic priming? *Language, Cognition, and Neuroscience*, 39(4), 455–488. <https://doi.org/10.1080/23273798.2024.2328586>
- **Korochkina, M.**, Marelli, M., Brysbaert, M., & Rastle, K. (2024). The Children and Young People's Books Lexicon (CYP-LEX): A large-scale lexical database of books read by children and young people in the United Kingdom. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 77(12), 2418–2438. <https://doi.org/10.1177/17470218241229694>
- Lombard, A., Ulicheva, A., **Korochkina, M.**, & Rastle, K. (2024). The regularity of polysemy patterns in the mind: Computational and experimental data. *GLOSSA Psycholinguistics*, 3(1), 3, 1–24. <https://doi.org/10.5070/G60111327>
- **Korochkina, M.**, Sowman, P., Nickels, L., & Bürki, A. (2023). Neural correlates of encoding in novel word learning. *Collabra: Psychology*, 9(1), 57525. <https://doi.org/10.1525/collabra.57525>
- **Korochkina, M.**, Bürki, A., & Nickels, L. (2021). Apples and oranges: How does learning context affect novel word learning? *Journal of Memory and Language*, 120, 104246. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jml.2021.104246>

Recent talks (selected)

A full list of talks (including slides) is available at <https://mariakna.github.io>.

- *Modelling affix learning from reading: Insights from compositional distributional semantics*. The annual meeting of experimental psychologists (TeaP), Tübingen, Germany, March 2026.
- *Learning affixes through text experience: A new theoretical and computational framework*. **Invited** talk, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit (CBU), University of Cambridge, October 2025.
- *Morpheme knowledge is shaped by information available through orthography*. The 24th meeting of the European Society for Cognitive Psychology, Sheffield, UK, September 2025.
- *What and how do we learn about morphemes through reading experience?* Annual meeting of the Experimental Psychology Society, Lancaster, UK, April 2025.
- *The nature of morphemic regularities in children's literature: What do British children learn about derivational morphology when they read?* The 31st annual meeting of the Society for the Scientific Study of Reading, Copenhagen, Denmark, July 2024.

- *What can children learn about English morphology through book reading?* Annual meeting of the Experimental Psychology Society, York, UK, July 2024.
- *What do children read as they transition into and through adolescence? Insights from CYP-LEX, a new large-scale lexicon of books for children and young people.* Annual meeting of the Cognitive and Developmental sections of the British Psychological Society, Bristol, UK, September 2023.
- *The Children and Young People's Books Lexicon (CYP-LEX): A lexical database of books directed at children and young adults.* The 23rd meeting of the European Society for Cognitive Psychology, Porto, Portugal, September 2023.
- *The Children and Young People's Books Lexicon (CYP-LEX): How does book language change as children transition into and through adolescence?* Annual meeting of the Experimental Psychology Society, Swansea, UK, July 2023.

Outreach contributions

Publications

- *What can children learn about morphology from reading for fun?* (2025) Blog post.
- *What makes GCSE English Literature so hard for students?* (2024) *Tes*.
- *What words do children encounter when they read for pleasure?* (2024) *Nomanis*. Also available as a [blog post](#).

Talks

- *The words children meet in books: Evidence from a 70-million-word corpus.* **Invited** talk for [Renaissance International](#), 22 April 2026
- *The power of reading for children's outcomes: What every parent needs to know.* **Invited** webinar for [Tooled Up Education](#), 5 November 2025.
- *The words children and young people encounter when they read for pleasure, and what it means for learning* (June 2025). [Working Together: Research and Practice meeting 2025](#), The South East Research Network for Schools, Egham, UK.
- *Words in books: A challenge, a blessing, or both?* (Sept 2024). **Invited** talk, [ResearchED National Conference](#), London, UK.
- *What makes GCSE English Literature so hard for students?* (June 2024). [Working Together: Research and Practice meeting 2024](#), The South East Research Network for Schools, Egham, UK.

Awards and funding

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| 2023 | ■ Student Researcher Credibility Prize , The British Neuroscience Association |
| 2021 | ■ The Carpentries Instructor Training (A\$1,500), Macquarie University |
| 2020 | ■ Postgraduate Research Fund , (A\$5,000), Macquarie University
Competitive university-wide award for international conferences and lab visits |
| 2019 | ■ Conference travel & participant recruitment awards , University of Potsdam (€2,000) |
| 2018–2022 | ■ PhD Fellowship , IDEALAB
Highly competitive fellowship providing full tuition, stipend, and travel costs |
| 2012 & 2014 | ■ Student exchange awards , University of Vienna, Austria
Competitive awards providing tuition and stipend for 2 semesters |

Professional service

Peer-review	■ Editorial board: Journal of Psycholinguistic Research Reviewer: <i>Psychological Science</i> ; <i>Psychonomic Bulletin & Review</i> ; <i>Behavior Research Methods</i> ; <i>Journal of Memory and Language</i> ; <i>Instructional Science</i> ; <i>Cognitive Science, Language, Cognition, & Neuroscience</i> ; <i>Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience</i> ; <i>Journal of Research in Reading</i> ; <i>Advances in Cognitive Psychology</i> ; <i>Psychology & Neuroscience</i> Conference abstract reviewer: <i>Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)</i> 2024 & 2025
Open science	■ 2022–2025, Lead , ReproducibiliTea club , Royal Holloway, Univ. of London
Equality, diversity, & inclusion	■ 2024–present, Mentor , In2research

Skills

Experimental techniques	■ Behavioural, EEG, NLP, corpus linguistics, eye-tracking, comput. modelling
Programming languages & software	■ MATLAB, Python, R, Stan, Presentation Neurobehav. Systems, $\LaTeX$
Languages	■ English, German, Russian, Swedish, Icelandic, BSL (beginner)

Training and development (selected)

2025	■ Best practices for the processing and analysis of eye movements during reading , University College London
2024	■ <i>Introduction to Research Impact</i> , Royal Holloway, Univ. of London ■ <i>Storytelling with Impact: Visual storytelling</i> , Nifty Fox Creative ■ <i>Storytelling with Impact: Unleash the power of narrative</i> , Duncan Yellowlees ■ <i>Storytelling to success: Developing your Narrative CV</i> , University of Leeds
2023	■ <i>Effective Grant Writing</i> , Royal Holloway, Univ. of London
2022	■ <i>Introduction to Natural Language Processing in Python</i> , DataCamp ■ <i>The 6th Summer School on Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology</i> , University of Potsdam
2021	■ <i>Badged Instructor</i> , The Carpentries
2020	■ <i>Understanding the Brain: The Neurobiology of Everyday Life</i> , University of Chicago